SpeechGeek



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You may be wondering what's up with the photo of the girl in short sleeves on the cover of the Winter 2007 issue. Oh, you didn't? Well, go ahead and ask yourself that question, otherwise this little rant won't make sense. Question posed? Good. Winter brings to mind cold weather (for most of the country, at least). It's also one of the busiest parts of the competitive forensics season. It's that time of year where things begin to come together: you get a feel for your character, the blocking of your duo is finally solid, and you've (at last!) learned to go to bed early the night before a tournament rather than run that intro one last time. Well, you may want to run the intro once more. It was kind of shaky in practice rounds the other day.

We're happy to welcome Paul Davis back for his second season providing some challenging and wonderful scripts. Paul is an out-there kind of guy, but his scripts pack a punch!.

Corey Alderdice
Publisher

p.s. I honestly don't know why she has on short sleeves. She's probably from Texas. Wait a minute, I know she's from Texas. Whew! I knew there was an explanation somewhere.

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Trash Can Heart

by Paul Davis

So you probably want to hear about the day all that messed up stuff happened. That's all everyone wants to hear about. Can't really blame you. Not much happens at high schools in Utah. At least not in mine. Nothing exciting ever really happened until the day we found Jared Gurrero's heart in a trash can.

Of course we didn't know it was Jared Gurrero's heart until later. Some sophomore found the heart in a garbage can next to his locker. He looked at it for a while before he told anyone. And then he told some other kids. So there was basically a bunch of kids standing around this trash can looking at a bloody heart, trying to decide if it was real or not. Some butthead, I think his name was John or something, decided that it wasn't and picked it up out of the garbage can for a joke. The joke didn't go so well, cause after he picked it up, he suddenly realized it was real for some reason, so then he dropped it on the ground and started screaming. There was blood on his hands and everyone started freaking out. Administrative people came down with security and decided that the heart was real and canceled school for that day and called the cops. Everyone was pretty happy about school being cancelled, but we couldn't leave since everyone had to wait for the cops to tell them everything they saw. I had to take a pee, so I went to the bathroom, but it was packed. All the kids were in there talking about what was going on. But I really had to go, so I went to the other bathroom across campus. That one was empty. Almost.

I went to a stall and relieved myself. And while I was going, I heard a strange noise. A soft kind of moaning or crying coming from a bathroom stall. "Hello," I said, wondering if the person was okay, but really just making sure I wasn't about to get my heart cut out. As I was hastily zipping up, accidentally getting some piss on my pants, I heard the stall door open and someone step out. I spun around to see Will, one of the special ed kids. He was one of the bigger ones, not giant, but bigger than me. He was kind of whimpering and I think crying and then I saw what he was holding. In is hand Will had clenched a bloody knife. I don't know where he got it on campus, maybe he brought it from home, but right then I knew that he was the one who cut out Jared Gurrero's heart. Of course I didn't know it was Jared Gurrero's heart at the time. I found that out later. But right then, I knew that Will was directly related to the heart in the garbage can, which was now on the ground or by now maybe even an evidence bag or something. "Hey, Will, what are you doing? Hey man, why don't you put that down." I was trying to talk softly, calm him down so that maybe he would drop the knife. But he just kept looking at me. I thought for sure that he was going to try and cut my heart out next. Then for some reason I started thinking that this was some kind of joke. That everyone was going to run in laughing and pat me on the back and give him a cookie or something for playing along. But right as I had that thought, I knew it wasn't true. This was too messed up and random for someone to plan as a joke. "Will, that would be awesome of you would put that knife down. Dude, knives aren't for playing around with. Put it down."

"Make the boys suffer," was what he said. Boy, I don't really know what he meant or where he got the idea to say that, but it sent chills down my spine. Suddenly I started racking my brain to remember if I had ever picked on Will. Lots of people laugh about the retards at school, but do they realize it while it's happening? "Make the boys suffer," he said again, stepping towards me. Now I was starting to panic. Even with him holding the knife he almost seemed docile, like he wouldn't use it. But I started to panic because it was dawning on me that he already had used it. Was it out of malice? Out of hate? Out of confusion? Did he consciously cut out the heart of a boy, or was it an innocent mistake, like Lenny from *Of Mice and Men*? We had to read that in our English class. As Will was stepping towards me, raising the knife, I wondered if he realized what he was

doing? Exacting revenge on the kids who were different? Or was he simply doing what seemed natural with a knife? What he had seen done on television and movies? Will lurched towards me, and for lack of anything better to do, instinctually, I just reached out and punched him in the face. It landed right on his nose, blood shot out and he started screaming. It was a horrible noise that made me automatically regret hitting him. Even though Will had killed a person, I felt bad for hitting him. He dropped the knife and reached for his face and I ran out of the bathroom.

I went to an official looking adult and told them where Will was and what I saw. The police arrested Will and took the knife as like, evidence. I wasn't really a hero or anything that day, but I told my story about twelve or fifteen times. Everyone wanted to hear about how I unarmed a killer. But I mean, man, it was a retarded kid. And I punched him in the nose. I sure didn't feel like a hero. Later that day, the gym coach found Jared Gurrero's body, sans heart, in the equipment room. They figured that Will just brought the knife from home for some reason, went to the locker room first thing in the morning and saw Jared Gurrero, where he, for some reason unknown to everyone but God and Will, attacked him and cut out his heart. Then he shoved the body in the equipment room, carried the heart around until he saw the trash can, and tossed it in. Then he went to that bathroom, went in the stall and cried or something. Perhaps he realized he did something wrong. Perhaps not. I don't know what it is that would possible drive anyone, retarded or not, to kill another. Especially to cut out his heart. To drive a weapon deep inside of someone, pry them open and remove a part of them. Arguably the most important part. The heart.

Well, that's about it I think. The day all that messed up stuff happened. The day we found Jared Gurrero with a gaping hole in his chest in the equipment room of the gym. The day I found Will with a bloody knife crying and moaning in the bathroom. And the day we found Jared Gurrero's heart in a trash can, thrown away like old homework, apple cores and yesterdays trash.